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'It's stage-managed'

...Home Affairs PS says some individuals are disguising themselves in rival political party regalia to shift blame

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Teenager dies in brother's rescue bid

By Ruth Mabita

Two children have drowned in the Lutembwe River in Kasenengwa District after a 19-year-old tried to save her 11-year-old brother.

The siblings, who had gone fishing with their 14-year-old cousin on Tuesday afternoon, entered a deep section of the river where the younger boy got into difficulty and both were swept under.

Eastern Province Police Commanding Officer Robertson Mweemba said the deceased, Mariah Mulauzi, returned from school shortly before 13:00 and persuaded her brother, Aziyele Mulauzi, and their cousin, Anthony Phiri, to go to the river about 2.5 kilometres from their village.

Aziyele, fishing with a mosquito net, moved into a deep, narrow part of the river, lost his footing and began to struggle. His sister entered the water to rescue him but both subsequently drowned, Mr Mweemba said.

Mr Mweemba added that Phiri ran back to the village to inform the children's father, who reported the incident to police. Officers, assisted by community members, recovered the bodies from the river.

Preliminary physical examinations found no evidence of foul play, he said. The family has been advised to bury the children and mark the graves in case post-mortem examinations are later required.



Secretary to the Cabinet Patrick Kangwa (r) confers with Oxford Lord Mayor Chewo Munkonge after receiving a gift from the civic leader in Lusaka today. Picture by Ruth Kambita.

Zambian-born Lord Mayor of Oxford pledges deep ties

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Real News in Real Time

UNZA student cheats death

Zambian-born Lord Mayor of Oxford pledges deep ties



By Linda Nyondo

An 18-year-old first-year student at the University of Zambia escaped serious injury after a Toyota Hiace minibus crashed through the wall of her boarding house in Lusaka.

The minibus, registration BLC 6102, is reported to have been travelling at speed when the driver lost control and struck the gate before ploughing through the yard and into the building at about 13:00 on Thursday.

The student, who is enrolled in the School of Humanities, had just finished bathing and was getting dressed when the vehicle burst into the room. She wrapped herself in a blanket and began crying, she told the Real Times.

"I first thought the bang was outside, then I saw a minibus in our room. The next thing people were screaming and jumping out of the bus," Luyando Luya said.

Apart from destroying walls and damaged property, Luyando said she also lost nearly all her food, electrical items and other possessions.

Her roommate, who was away visiting family outside Lusaka,

also lost belongings stored at the house.

The two students have been moved to alternative accommodation.

Police from Ngombe rushed to the scene and helped the injured, both passengers from the minibus and residents of the boarding house.

Unconfirmed reports say five people were taken to Ng'ombe Clinic while others walked away unhurt.

A visitor who was at the house at the time confirmed Luyando's account.

An eyewitness, who asked not to be named, said the driver appeared to lose control after hitting a hump on the road, then collided with the gate and the building.

At the time of the interview, the whereabouts of the minibus driver were unknown. The owner of the boarding house said they were trying to contact the employer of the driver to agree compensation for the damage.

"I can only thank God for saving my life," Luyando said. "The bus crushed through the walls and missed hitting me by an inch. I have survived."

By Ruth Kambita

Lord Mayor Chewe Munkonge, the first Black Lord Mayor of Oxford, has pledged to use his 2026–27 civic year to deepen ties between Zambia and the United Kingdom, prioritising education, investment and research partnerships.

Speaking during a courtesy call on the Secretary to the Cabinet, Patrick Kangwa, in Lusaka today, Lord Mayor Munkonge described his return to Zambia as an emotional homecoming.

He said his journey from humble beginnings in Zambia to one of Britain's oldest civic

offices should inspire young people.

"I am humbled to be the first Black lord mayor of Oxford for the 2026–2027 civic year. I am proud to have come from Zambia, and I want the relationship between Zambia and the United Kingdom to grow even stronger," he said.

Lord Mayor Munkonge said his office will focus on strengthening cooperation between Oxford and Zambia by expanding academic links and research collaboration between Zambian universities and Oxford institutions.

He said he would also encourage investment and

business partnerships to attract opportunities to Zambia, and mobilising Oxford-based Zambian organisations to support development initiatives at home.

Lord Mayor Mukonge said his experience in UK public service and politics positions him to champion sustained people-to-people and institutional links.

Mr Kangwa congratulated Lord Mayor Munkonge on his historic election and described the visit as an important moment to reinforce the long-standing Zambia-UK relationship.

He urged that talks be directed towards practical

cooperation in education, public health, climate science and agriculture, and called for expanded scholarships and research partnerships.

He also acknowledged the role of international partners in Zambia's recent economic progress and invited ongoing collaboration across ministries and institutions.

The visit follows earlier exchanges between Oxford and Zambian local authorities and reinforces calls for greater diaspora engagement to support national development. Government offices have pledged openness to follow-up discussions and concrete agreements.

LWSC secures bulk water for LS-MFEZ

By Alex Maboshe

The Lusaka Water Supply and Sanitation Company (LWSC) has begun work on a dedicated bulk water supply to support industries in the Lusaka South Multi-Facility Economic Zone (LSMFEZ).

In a statement, LWSC Public Relations Officer Ruth Mukuwa said the project includes construction of a 15-kilometre bulk water pipeline, electromechanical works at the Libala Water Works and new storage facilities within the economic zone.

Once complete, the scheme will deliver 10,000 cubic metres equivalent to 10 million litres of treated water a day to industries operating in the LSMFEZ

and will also improve supply reliability for neighbouring communities, Ms Mukuwa said.

The initiative is being implemented under a Public Private Partnership between LWSC and the Lusaka South Multi-Facility Economic Zone.

Ms Mukuwa described

it as evidence of the company's commitment to strategic partnerships that provide critical infrastructure for trade, investment and sustainable growth.

She said it responds to rising demand for reliable, high quality water driven by expanding industrial activity in the zone.

"Dependable water supply is essential for manufacturing, commercial operations and business expansion," Ms Mukuwa said. "By providing dedicated bulk water infrastructure, LWSC aims to create a more enabling environment for investors and enterprises."

SADC deploys 106 Election Observers

By Alex Maboshe

The Southern African Development Community (SADC) has officially launched its Electoral Observation Mission for Zambia's general elections on 13 August, deploying 106 observers across all ten provinces to monitor the electoral process before, during and after polling day.

The mission is led by Samuel Tembenu, former Malawi Minister of Justice and Constitutional Affairs.

It will assess the independence and readiness of the Electoral Commission of Zambia, the country's electoral

laws, political party participation, media access, the neutrality of security forces, voter education and the handling of ballot papers.

Observers will also monitor voting, counting, tabulation and the announcement of results, as well as the mechanisms available for resolving electoral disputes.

Professor Kula Theletsane, Director of the SADC Organ on Politics, Defence and Security Affairs, said the deployment forms part of SADC's ongoing commitment to strengthening democratic processes in the region.

He called on political play-

ers and citizens to ensure the elections remain peaceful and free from violence or intimidation.

SADC has stressed that its role is not to police or interfere in Zambia's electoral process.

Instead, the mission will independently observe and assess the elections, with its findings due to be released in a report on 15 August.

Observers will not intervene in any issues they encounter or make public statements during the process.

They will document their observations and include recommendations in the final report.

‘General’ Kanene cries for peace

By Alex Maboshe

Zambian music veteran General Kanene, also known as 2Pac Wamu Zambia and born Clifford Dimba, has released a new single titled "Tisayambe Kumenyana" translated as "Say No to Political Violence".

The eight-minute track urges citizens to reject political clashes and prioritise national unity ahead of the general election on 13 August, now seven days away.

The single arrives amid heightened political tensions and follows an incident in which the artist was injured while performing at a campaign event in Shibuyunji for Ibrahim Kabwe Mwamba, the parliamentary candidate for Mwembeshi East Constituency.

On the record, Kanene adopts his signature narrative delivery over a blend of traditional Zambian rhythms and contemporary beats, urging listeners not to destroy homes, markets or relationships over politics.

The lyrics stress peaceful co-existence, referencing everyday struggles and asserting that Zambia is one nation.

Lines from the song warn against plotting harm because of political differences and call on people to stand together rather than fight.

The official description of

the release carries the simple message: "Say No to Political Violence."

Fans have embraced the single. Released on Kanene's YouTube channel, it has attracted tens of thousands of views and thousands of likes within hours, with comments coming from Zambia and neighbouring Malawi praising its timely message.

Many well-wishers also used

the comment thread to send recovery wishes after reports of the recent attack.

General Kanene has long combined social commentary with entertainment, building a loyal following through songs that address real-life issues in a storytelling style.

This latest offering continues that tradition, positioning music as a means to calm tensions rather than fuel them.

‘It’s stage-managed’

By Alex Maboshe

Ministry of Home Affairs and Internal Security Permanent Secretary Dickson Matembo has accused some individuals of disguising themselves in the regalia of rival political parties after committing acts of violence in an apparent attempt to shift blame.

Speaking to journalists in Lusaka today, Mr Matembo said the government was aware of what he described as "stage-managed violence" aimed at creating instability.

He said President Hakainde Hichilema had consistently opposed political violence and warned that anyone found breaking the law would be held personally responsible.

"The government will not tolerate political violence and those involved will face the full force of the law, regardless of their political affiliation," Mr Matembo said.

At the same briefing, Ministry of Information Permanent Secretary Thabo Kawana said the recent incidents of violence had been deliberately orchestrated by some political actors to discredit the government and the President ahead of the general election on 13 August.

Mr Kawana said the strategy was intended to portray the country as unstable and to influence public opinion against President Hichilema.

He urged the Zambia Police Service to investigate all incidents thoroughly and arrest those responsible.

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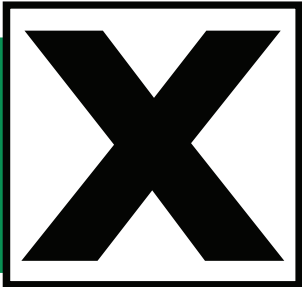
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‘Tear-break’ exit

...Copper Queens knocked out of Wafcon despite topping group



By Benedict Tembo

Zambia suffered the ignominy of first-round elimination from the Women's Africa Cup of Nations tournament despite statistically heading Group C following a hard-fought 2-1 victory over neighbouring Malawi on Wednesday night.

Top scorer Barbara Banda and Prisca Chilufya scored in the first half but one of the Chawinga sisters - Tabitha - arrowed one in, a goal that technically knocked the Copper Queens out.

While many Zambians were celebrating the victory on the assumption that Zambia had topped the group and qualified, reality sunk in later when tiebreak rules played in.

Zambia were top of the pile with six points by virtue of the superior-most statistics, having collected six points, scored eight goals and conceded only three.

But there was tiebreak catch: Nigeria and Malawi also had six points despite having an inferior goal-difference. That brought in tailenders and pointless Egypt, whose games against all the top three were dropped, leaving only the triumvirate to contest for qualification.

That, as guided by CAF tiebreak rules, left Zambia, Malawi and Nigeria to contest for the top two, each now with three points.

From the two games each played in this "mini" league, all teams tallied on goal-difference, bringing into play the goals scored rule. Zambia had

the worst as they only scored two, Nigeria had three goals while Malawi had the bragging rights with four goals.

The early elimination effectively rules the Copper Queens out of running for a place at the World Cup in Brazil next year.

VICTORY OVER MALAWI

Zambia made the perfect start when Banda opened the scoring inside the first minute.

The tournament's leading scorer unleashed a powerful long-range strike to net her fifth goal of the competition.

The Copper Queens continued to create chances and nearly doubled their lead in the 18th minute, but Irene Lungu's well-taken free-kick was pushed away by Malawi goalkeeper Mercy Sikelo.

Zambia got their second goal eight minutes before halftime after Margaret Bel-emu picked out Chilufya with a cutback from the right, and the forward calmly fired home to give the Copper Queens a comfortable 2-0 lead.

Malawi pulled one goal back in the second half, setting up a tense finish.

Both teams created opportunities in the closing minutes, with Zambia pushing for more goals as goal difference proved crucial in the race for qualification.

Despite securing all three points, the Copper Queens' 2-1 victory was not enough to keep their WAFCON campaign alive, as they exited the tournament at the group stage.

Pre-tournament favourites Zambia is among seven countries that have been eliminated from the ongoing WAFCON, in Morocco.

Zambia who were making their fourth appearance joined Egypt, Burkina Faso, Cape Verde, Senegal, Kenya and Tanzania.

The teams were knocked out of the tournament following the conclusion of earlier group matches played on Monday, Tuesday and Wednesday.

Although the Copper Queens bowed out, they will leave Morocco with plenty of positives after winning two matches and losing only one match in the tournament, scoring eight goals and conceding only one goal in all three group matches.

Golfers rewarded with goats, vegetables after Farmers Day tourney

By Benedict Tembo

The 2026 Farmers Day golf tournament on Monday lived to its tradition as winners were handsomely rewarded with farm produce.

The Cross Country Golf Tournament, which took place on the final day of the 98th Agricultural and Commercial Show was held in honour of this year's Farmers' Day, whose theme was "Fostering Trade and Investment."

Winners in every 'C', 'B' and 'A' Divisions walked away with a goat each, a trays of eggs, tomatoes, and cabbages while runners-up got a trays of eggs, tomatoes, and cabbages in the individual stableford event staged at Lusaka Golf Club on Monday - Farmers Day.

Muzo Simakolowi won the 'A' Division on 39 net followed by G. Kasonde who had 37 net while Ebrahim Patel got the third position on 36 net.

Man of the people Tapiwa Pasi received one of the biggest cheers when he was announced as the winner in the 'B' Division with 44 net where Charles Lilyali was runner-up on 42 net and Gilford Malenji had 42 net to finish third.

Shailesh Patel's 42 net gifted him the first position in the 'C' Division with Marcus Achiume

trailing in second place at 41 net but winning on countback from RC Mhango who settled for the number three position.

In the ladies section, Mulala Chipanta was the winner with 40 net, Maggie Banda was the runner-up on 38 net, winning on countback from Elisa Manjolo.

In subsidiaries, Humphrey Chisanga bagged the nearest to the pin prize, with the longest drive accolade going to Boyd Kapalamoto and Natasha Ngoma getting the longest drive for ladies.

Sydney Wemba and Kapalamoto shared spoils in the professional ranks on 39

and 33 net respectively, with three elite amateurs Kapoma Musamba (66 net), Robert Mofya (68 net) and Fabian Musonda (70 net) being recognised as emblems of golf development.

President of the Agricultural and Commercial Society of Zambia (ACSZ) René Lourens said this year's Show demonstrated significant progress, as the agricultural and livestock exhibits clearly indicated a recovery from the drought conditions that affected our nation during the 2024-2025 farming season.

Lourens said the recovery will be further highlighted as

we present awards to our winners with these very produce.

On the golf tournament, the ACSZ president believed the event provided the farmers with an excellent opportunity for networking, interaction, and the exchange of ideas outside of their agricultural environments.

"We encourage you to share your experiences with us to help us enhance participation and other services associated with this function. As ACSZ, we are proud of the progress, tenacity, and resilience demonstrated," Lourens said.

Looking ahead, Lourens said the ACSZ was 24 months

away from hosting the Centenary Show, where golfers and farmers will have the opportunity to participate in a Centenary Cross Country Golf Tournament for ACSZ in 2028.

"Your support, connections, and potential sponsorship are what drive the Show Society to prepare for events such as this one," he said.

Lourens said the ACSZ looked forward to the 99th Show, which will be held from July 27 to August 2, 2027, under the theme "Shaping Future Opportunities."

"Our tournament in 2027 will therefore be held on August 2nd, 2027," he said.

Top golfers head to Lusaka for elite training camp

By Benedict Tembo

The Zambia Golf Union (ZGU) will this week stage the National Golf High-Performance Camp Lusaka Golf Club.

The upskill camp billed for tomorrow, August 7 to Sunday, August 9 and fully supported by ZGU and the R&A aims to sharpen skills for elite level golfers in course management and physical conditioning through top-tier international instruction.

The event will be facilitated by three professional

coaches from South Africa.

The ZGU has picked 12 top male amateur golfers to participate in the course.

The selected players include Stalian Daka, recently-turned professional Musamba Kapoma, Blackwell Mwandila, Joseph Sichone, Dominic Musonda, Simon Lumbwe, ever improving Killian Hapwita and Joshua Milambo.

Others are female golfers Annie Nsama, Gracious Mwenda, Deborah Changa and Kusefya M. Musonda.

Local coaches selected to undergo skills transfer Mwango Mukuka, Timothy Sondashi, Esther Wemba,

Morton Muwowo, Aron Simfukwe Jnr, Kaela Mulenga and Patrick Mwendapole.

In a memo dated August 2, addressed to golf club captains, ZGU General Secretary Edward Phiri said all the all selected players must arrive in Lusaka by Thursday, August 6, 2026 at 15:00 hours dressed in full golf attire.

"Please assist the players with transport to the camp venue. The Union will take care of the return fares. Let them carry their golf bags and seek consent from their parents and guardians," Phiri said.